

**DEPARTMENT OF ELECTRICAL AND ELECTRONIC ENGINEERING
COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY
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Title of Exercise : ANALYSIS OF DIFFERENT REFERENCING STYLE
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Date of Exercise :

REFERENCING STYLE

AIM:

To demonstrate a detailed, systematic understanding of the differences in structure, application, and conventions across six major referencing styles: APA, MLA, Chicago/Turabian, Harvard, IEEE, and Vancouver.

INTRODUCTION:

Referencing styles are **standardized rules** for formally acknowledging the sources of information (ideas, quotes, data, etc.) used in academic writing. They serve as a roadmap, allowing readers to easily locate the materials you consulted and enabling you to give proper **credit to the original author**.

In short, a referencing style is a consistent format that dictates two things:

1. **In-text citation:** How sources are noted *within* the body of your paper (e.g., (Smith, 2020) or [1]).
2. **Reference list/Bibliography:** How the full publication details are listed *at the end* of your paper (e.g., APA, MLA, IEEE).

The primary purpose is to maintain **academic integrity**, avoid **plagiarism**, and ensure the **credibility** and verifiability of your research. Different disciplines use different styles (e.g., APA for science, MLA for humanities) because they prioritize different elements of a source, such as the date, the author, or the sequence of ideas.

1. **APA (American Psychological Association)**
2. **MLA (Modern Language Association)**
3. **Chicago/Turabian (Chicago Manual of Style)**
4. **Harvard**
5. **IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers)**
6. **Vancouver**

1. APA (American Psychological Association)

1. Journal article

Grady, J. S., Her, M., Moreno, G., Perez, C., & Yelinek, J. (2019). Emotions in storybooks: A comparison of storybooks that represent ethnic and racial groups in the United States. *Psychology of Popular Media Culture*, 8(3), 207–217. <https://doi.org/10.1037/ppm0000185>

- **Parenthetical citations:** (Grady et al., 2019; Pope & Wall, 2025; Rybaczewska & Sparks, 2022)
- **Narrative citations:** Grady et al. (2019), Pope and Wall (2025), and Rybaczewska and Sparks (2022)

2. Journal article with an article number

Jerrentrup, A., Mueller, T., Glowalla, U., Herder, M., Henrichs, N., Neubauer, A., & Schaefer, J. R. (2018). Teaching medicine with the help of “Dr. House.” *PLoS ONE*, 13(3), Article e0193972. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0193972>

- **parenthetical citations:** (Jerrentrup et al., 2018; Schlesselmann et al., 2025)
- **Narrative citations:** Jerrentrup et al. (2018) and Schlesselmann et al. (2025)

3. Journal article with missing information

Missing volume number

Lipscomb, A. Y. (2021, Winter). Addressing trauma in the college essay writing process. *The Journal of College Admission*, (249), 30–33. https://www.catholiccollegesonline.org/pdf/national_ccaa_in_the_news_-_nacac_journal_of_college_admission_winter_2021.pdf

Missing issue number

Bosco, G., Rizzato, A., Moon, R. E., & Camporesi, E. M. (2018). Environmental physiology and diving medicine. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 9, Article 72. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2018.00072>

Missing page or article number

Butler, J. (2017). Where access meets multimodality: The case of ASL music videos. *Kairos: A Journal of Rhetoric, Technology, and Pedagogy*, 21(1). <http://technorhetoric.net/21.1/topoi/butler/index.html>

- **Parenthetical citations:** (Bosco et al., 2018; Butler, 2017; Lipscomb, 2021; Sanchiz et al., 2017)
- **Narrative citations:** Bosco et al. (2018), Butler (2017), Lipscomb (2021), and Sanchiz et al. (2017)

4. Retracted journal article

Joly, J. F., Stapel, D. A., & Lindenberg, S. M. (2008). Silence and table manners: When environments activate norms. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 34(8), 1047–1056. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0146167208318401> (Retraction published 2012, *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 38[10], 1378)

- **Parenthetical citation:** (Joly et al., 2008)
- **Narrative citation:** Joly et al. (2008)

5. Retraction notice for a journal article

The Editors of The Lancet. (2010). Retraction—Ileal-lymphoid-nodular hyperplasia, non-specific colitis, and pervasive developmental disorder in children. *The Lancet*, 375(9713), 445. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736\(10\)60175-4](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736(10)60175-4)

- **Parenthetical citations:** (de la Fuente et al., 2010; The Editors of the Lancet, 2010)
- **Narrative citations:** de la Fuente et al. (2010) and The Editors of the Lancet (2010)

6. Abstract of a journal article from an abstract indexing database

Hare, L. R., & O'Neill, K. (2000). Effectiveness and efficiency in small academic peer groups: A case study (Accession No. 200010185) [Abstract from Sociological Abstracts]. *Small Group Research*, 31(1), 24–53. <https://doi.org/10.1177/104649640003100102>

- ***Parenthetical citation:*** (Hare & O'Neill, 2000)
- ***Narrative citation:*** Hare and O'Neill (2000)

7. Monograph as part of a journal issue

Ganster, D. C., Schaubroeck, J., Sime, W. E., & Mayes, B. T. (1991). The nomological validity of the Type A personality among employed adults [Monograph]. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 76(1), 143–168. <http://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.76.1.143>

- ***Parenthetical citation:*** (Ganster et al., 1991)
- ***Narrative citation:*** Ganster et al. (1991)

8. Online-only supplemental material to a journal article

Freeberg, T. M. (2019). From simple rules of individual proximity, complex and coordinated collective movement [Supplemental material]. *Journal of Comparative Psychology*, 133(2), 141–142. <https://doi.org/10.1037/com0000181>

- ***Parenthetical citation:*** (Freeberg, 2019)
- ***Narrative citation:*** Freeberg (2019)

1. APA (American Psychological Association) - 7th Edition

Category	Guideline	Example
Field of Study	Social Sciences (Psychology, Education), Business, and Nursing.	
General Format	Author-Date system. Uses a Reference List (double-spaced, hanging indent, alphabetized).	
In-Text Citations	Parenthetical: (Author, Year). Narrative: Author (Year).	Research has shown (Smith, 2023). (Smith, 2023, p. 14) (for direct quotes). (Smith et al., 2023) (for 3+ authors).
Reference List (Book)	Author, A. A. (Year). <i>Title of the book: Subtitle</i> (Xth ed.). Publisher. DOI or URL.	Doe, J. M. (2023). <i>The practice of mindfulness</i> (4th ed.). Academic Press.
Reference List (Journal)	Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of the article. <i>Journal Name</i> , Volume(Issue), page range. DOI.	Johnson, L. R. (2022). The digital divide in education. <i>Journal of Applied Psychology</i> , 75(4), 412–425. https://doi.org/10.xxxx/JAP.2022.01.001
Tables & Figures	TABLES are numbered consecutively (Table 1 , Table 2) with the label and title above the table. FIGURES (charts, graphs) are numbered consecutively (Figure 1 , Figure 2) with the label and title above the figure.	Figure 1 <i>Proposed Model for Emotional Regulation (Image/Graph)</i> Note. From <i>Title of Source</i> (p. 5), by J. K. Author, 2023, Publisher.

2. MLA (Modern Language Association) - 9th Edition

Category	Guideline	Example
Field of Study	Humanities (Literature, Languages, Film, Cultural Studies).	
General Format	Author-Page system. Uses a Works Cited list (double-spaced, hanging indent, alphabetized).	
In-Text Citations	(Author Page Number) . If the author is named in the text, only the page number is needed.	The theory suggests a new approach (Said 45). Said argues the approach is new (45). (Said et al. 45) (for 3+ authors).
Works Cited (Book)	Author Last, First. <i>Title of Book</i> . Publisher, Year.	Smith, John A. <i>The American Novel</i> . Oxford UP, 2023.
Works Cited (Journal)	Author Last, First. "Title of Article." <i>Title of Journal</i> , vol. X, no. X, Day Month Year, pp. page range. <i>Database Name</i> , DOI, or URL.	Baker, Lily E. "Postmodern Poetics." <i>Journal of Literary Review</i> , vol. 90, no. 3, Fall 2022, pp. 112–28. <i>JSTOR</i> , doi:10.xxxx/JLIT.90.3.112.
Tables & Illustrations	FIGURES (any non-table image) are labelled Fig. 1 below the image. TABLES are labelled Table 1 (without a period) and titled above the table. Source information can be a full citation in the caption .	Fig. 1. The Evolution of the Symbol. Artwork by A. P. Jones, 2023.

3. Chicago/Turabian (Chicago Manual of Style) - 17th Edition

Chicago offers two distinct citation systems: **Notes and Bibliography (NB)**, used primarily in History and Humanities, and **Author-Date (AD)**, used in Social Sciences.

Category	Notes & Bibliography (NB)	Author-Date (AD)
Field of Study	History, Arts, Literature.	Social Sciences, Physical Sciences.
General Format	Uses Footnotes or Endnotes and a Bibliography (alphabetized).	Uses parenthetical citations and a Reference List (alphabetized, year after author).
In-Text Citations	Superscript number (1), corresponding to a note.	(Author Year, Page) . Short form is often (Author Year).
Bibliography (NB)	Last Name, First Name. <i>Title of Book</i> . Place: Publisher, Year.	References: Last Name, First Name. Year. <i>Title of Book</i> . Place: Publisher.
Example (Book)	1 Jane M. Doe, <i>Ancient Law</i> (Academic Press, 2023), 45.	References: Doe, Jane M. 2023. <i>Ancient Law</i> . Chicago: Academic Press.
Example (Journal)	2 John A. Smith, "The Role of Climate," <i>J. of Historical Studies</i> 75, no. 4 (2022): 412.	References: Smith, John A. 2022. "The Role of Climate." <i>Journal of Historical Studies</i> 75, no. 4 (Winter): 412–25.
Tables & Figures	Both tables and figures are numbered consecutively and cited in the text by number (e.g., "as figure 2 shows"). Captions begin with Figure 1. (below figure) or Table 1. (above table) and include a credit line (source information).	

4. Harvard

Category	Guideline	Example
Field of Study	General academic use, prevalent in the UK, Australia (Economics, Business, Science).	
General Format	Author-Date system. Uses a Reference List (double-spaced, alphabetized). Note: Format details vary by institution.	
In-Text Citations	(Author, Year) or (Author, Year, p. X) . Punctuation outside the bracket.	This data is confirmed (Jones, 2023, p. 55). Jones (2023) explored...
Reference List (Book)	Author Surname, Initial(s). (Year) <i>Title of book</i> , Edition (if applicable), Publisher, Place of publication.	Smith, J.A. (2023) <i>Principles of Finance</i> , 2nd edn, Academic Press, London.
Reference List (Journal)	Author Surname, Initial(s). (Year) 'Title of article', <i>Title of Journal</i> , vol. X, no. X, pp. page range. DOI or available at: URL (Accessed: Day Month Year).	Baker, L.E. (2022) 'Corporate social responsibility', <i>J. Bus. Ethics</i> , vol. 75, no. 4, pp. 412–425.
Tables & Figures	TABLES and FIGURES are numbered sequentially. The source citation is placed below the figure/table label, often preceded by "Source:" or "Adapted from:". The source must have a corresponding full entry in the Reference List.	Figure 1: <i>Supply and Demand Curve</i> Source: Adapted from Smith (2023, p. 55).

5. IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers)

Category	Guideline	Example
Field of Study	Engineering (Electrical, Computer, Software), Computer Science, and Information Technology.	
General Format	Numerical system based on the order of first citation. Uses a References list (numbered, single-spaced internally, with a hanging indent).	
In-Text Citations	The number is enclosed in square brackets on the text line: [#].	This approach was first tested in 2023 [1]. Smith [2] concluded that...
Citing Multiple Sources	List numbers individually with commas, or use a dash for a range.	The findings are consistent with several prior works [3], [4], [6]–[8].
Citing Specific Parts	Include the page, figure, or equation number within the brackets.	As specified in the manual [5, p. 15]. The cross-reference notation is [6, Fig. 2].
Reference List (Book)	J. K. Author, <i>Title of Book</i> , xth ed. City, State Abbrev. (if US): Publisher, year.	[1] J. M. Doe, <i>Digital Communication Systems</i> . New York, NY, USA: Academic Press, 2023.
Reference List (Journal Article)	J. K. Author, "Title of article," <i>Abbrev. Title of Journal</i> , vol. volume, no. issue, pp. page range, Abbrev. Month, year. doi: (if available).	[2] K. D. Brown, "A framework for high-level synthesis," <i>IEEE Trans. Comput.-Aided Des. Integr. Circuits Syst.</i> , vol. 12, no. 1, pp. 10–25, Jan. 2023.
Tables, Figures, and Equations	Numbering: Figures use Arabic numerals (Fig. 1 , Fig. 2). Tables use Roman numerals (TABLE I , TABLE II). Equations use Arabic numerals in parentheses ((1) , (2)), right-aligned.	
Citing Visuals/Math	Fig. 1 is placed <i>below</i> the figure. TABLE I is placed <i>above</i> the table. Refer to them	Caption Example: Fig. 1. Comparison of neural network

Category	Guideline	Example
	as Fig. 1 or Table I in the text. Refer to equations by number: (1) .	prediction accuracy (based on data from [7]).

6. Vancouver (ICMJE/NLM)

Category	Guideline	Example
Field of Study	Biomedical Sciences, Medicine, Public Health, and Clinical Journals.	
General Format	Numerical system, based on the order of appearance. Uses a Reference List (numbered sequentially, <i>not</i> alphabetized).	
In-Text Citations	Superscript number (1) or number in parentheses ((1)). The number corresponds to the entry in the Reference List.	The finding was confirmed by several trials ^{1,2} \$. A key intervention was proposed (3).
Reference List (Book)	#. Author Last Initial(s). Book title. Edition number ed. City: Publisher; Year.	1. Smith JA. Clinical practice guidelines. 2nd ed. New York: Academic Press; 2023.
Reference List (Journal)	#. Author Last Initial(s). Article title. Abbreviated Journal Title. Year; Volume(Issue): page range.	2. Johnson LR, Williams PE. Impact of sugar on heart health. Am J Clin Nutr. 2022;75(4):412–5.
Tables & Illustrations	FIGURES (clinical images, flowcharts) and TABLES are numbered sequentially (e.g., Fig. 1, Table 1). The source is cited with the in-text citation number in the caption or footnote beneath the visual.	Figure 1. Flowchart for patient assessment. (Reprinted with permission from reference 4.)

IEEE Overview

IEEE Referencing Format Guide

The IEEE style is a numerical system primarily used in engineering, computer science, and information technology. It emphasizes clarity and efficiency in citing technical sources.

I. General Format & In-Text Citations

The IEEE style uses a numerical system where sources are cited in the text using numbers enclosed in square brackets, corresponding to an entry in the "References" list.

Component	Guideline	Example
Citation System	Numerical, ordered by first appearance. The first source cited is [1], the second is [2], and so on.	The process was validated by earlier research [1].
Repeating Citations	Use the same number for all subsequent citations of the same source throughout the paper.	However, subsequent studies [1] challenged this outcome.
Author Mention	When referring to an author in the text, include the citation number immediately after the name.	Smith and Jones [2] proposed a new filtering method.
Citing as a Noun	The bracketed number can be used as a noun in a sentence.	A key algorithm was introduced in [3].
Multiple Sources	Sources are listed separately using commas or combined using a range hyphen.	Several works [4], [5], [7] supported this hypothesis. OR

Component	Guideline	Example
Page/Section Specific	Include a specific page or section number inside the brackets when citing a direct quote or a specific detail.	The definition of a <i>transistor</i> is found in [8, p. 45].

II. Reference List (The "References" Section)

The list appears on a new page at the end of the paper, titled "References" (bold, centered, or flush left, depending on the document type/template). The entries are numbered and formatted according to the type of source.

➤ General Reference Rules:

- **Order:** Entries are numbered consecutively in the order they first **appeared** in the text, regardless of alphabetical order.
- **Author Names:** Use initials for first and middle names, followed by the full last name. (e.g., J. K. Smith)
- **Title Case:** Capitalize only the first word of the article/chapter title and any proper nouns.
- **Journal/Book Title:** The names of journals and books are italicized and written in Title Case (major words capitalized). Journal names are typically abbreviated according to IEEE standards.

Examples for Common Sources:

Source Type	Format	Example
Journal Article	J. K. Author, "Title of article," <i>Abbrev. Title of Journal</i> , vol. <i>volume</i> , no. <i>issue</i> , pp. <i>page range</i> , Abbrev. Month, year. doi: (if available).	[1] K. D. Brown, "A framework for high-level synthesis," <i>IEEE Trans. Comput. -Aided Des. Integr. Circuits Syst.</i> , vol. 12, no. 1, pp. 10–25, Jan. 2023.
Book	J. K. Author, <i>Title of Book</i> , <i>x</i> th ed. City, State Abbrev. (if US): Publisher, year.	[2] A. V. Oppenheim and R. W. Schaffer, <i>Discrete-Time Signal Processing</i> , 3rd ed. Upper Saddle River, NJ: Prentice Hall, 2020.
Book Chapter	J. K. Author, "Title of chapter in the book," in <i>Title of Published Book</i> , J. K. Editor, Ed. City: Publisher, year, pp. <i>page range</i> .	[3] J. H. Park, "System architecture for mobile devices," in <i>Handbook of Wireless Technology</i> , vol. 2, M. F. Chang, Ed. Hoboken, NJ: Wiley, 2022, pp. 145–170.

III. Citing Tables, Figures, and Equations

In IEEE style, figures, tables, and equations are treated as distinct entities, each with its own sequential numbering system, independent of the reference list.

- **Figures (Graphs, Diagrams, Images)**
- **In-Text Citation:** Always use the abbreviation "**Fig.**" (capitalized and followed by a number).
- **Numbering:** Figures are numbered consecutively with Arabic numerals: **Fig. 1**, **Fig. 2**, **Fig. 3**, etc.
- **Placement:** The caption is placed below the figure.

- **Format:** The caption starts with the figure number and is a descriptive title (sentence case).

Context	Example
In Text	The simulation results are depicted in Fig. 1.
Caption	Fig. 1. Comparison of neural network prediction accuracy over time.

2. Tables

- **In-Text Citation:** Refer to the table using the word "**Table**" followed by a number.
- **Numbering:** Tables are numbered consecutively with Roman numerals: **Table I**, **Table II**, **Table III**, etc.
- **Placement:** The caption is placed **above** the table.
- **Format:** The label "**TABLE I.**" is typically in Small Caps, centered, or flush left, and the descriptive title is placed underneath it.

Context	Example
In Text	The performance metrics are summarized in Table I.
Caption	TABLE I Key Performance Indicators for the Prototype System

3. Equations

- **In-Text Citation:** Refer to the equation only by its number in parentheses. **Do not use the word "Equation"** unless it begins a sentence.
- **Numbering:** Equations are numbered consecutively with Arabic numerals enclosed in parentheses, aligned to the **right** margin.
- **Format:** Variables are generally italicized.

Context	Example
Equation	$1/R_{\text{Total}} = 1/R_1 + 1/R_2$ (1)
In Text	The Total resistance is determined by (1).
Sentence Start	Equation (1) provides the basis for the calculation.

Citing Figures/Tables from a Source

If the table or figure itself is derived or directly copied from an external source, you must cite the reference number within the caption, often at the end.

- **Example (Figure Caption): Fig. 3.** Flowchart for decision logic (adapted from [5]).
- **Example (Table Caption): TABLE III** System Component Specifications (Data based on [7]).

1. APA (American Psychological Association)

Category	Description
Field of Study	Social Sciences (Psychology, Sociology, Education), Business, Nursing, and Criminology.
Primary Purpose	To emphasize the date of publication (recency) because current research is often most relevant in these empirical fields.
In-Text Citations	Author-Date system. Uses the author's last name and the year of publication in parentheses: (Author, Year) . For direct quotes, include the page or paragraph number: (Author, Year, p. X) .
Reference Style	Reference List (alphabetical by author). Uses initials for first names. Only the first word of the article/book title and proper nouns are capitalized (sentence case). Journal title is italicized and in Title Case.
Example (Book)	Doe, J. M. (2023). <i>The fundamentals of social learning theory</i> (3rd ed.). Academic Press.
Example (Journal Article)	Johnson, L. R. (2022). The Effects of Climate Anxiety on Urban Youth <i>Journal of Applied Psychology</i> , 75(4), 412–425. https://doi.org/10.xxxx/j.ap.2022.01.001
Citation Style	(Author-Date)
Common Use	Empirical research papers, dissertations, and literature reviews in the social and behavioural sciences.

2. MLA (Modern Language Association)

Category	Description
Field of Study	Humanities (Literature, Languages, Film Studies, Cultural Studies, Philosophy).
Primary Purpose	To emphasize authorship and location (page number), as interpretation of specific texts and close reading are central.
In-Text Citations	Author-Page system. Uses the author's last name and the page number in parentheses: (Author Page) . The year is only included in the text if necessary for clarity.
Reference Style	Works Cited list (alphabetical by author). Full first names are typically used. Titles of books and journals are italicized . Titles of articles are enclosed in quotation marks .
Example (Book)	Smith, John A. <i>The Poetics of the Modern Novel</i> . New York University Press, 2023.
Example (Journal Article)	Baker, Lily E. "The Victorian Era's Reflection in Modern Film." <i>Journal of English Literary History</i> , vol. 90, no. 3, 2022, pp. 112–28.
Citation Style	(Author-Page)
Common Use	Critical essays, literary analysis papers, and academic articles on language and culture.

3. Chicago/Turabian (Chicago Manual of Style)

Category	Description
Field of Study	History , Arts, Humanities, and some Social Sciences. Turabian is a student version often used for theses and dissertations.
Primary Purpose	To provide flexibility for different needs. The Notes system allows for complex source detail and commentary.
In-Text Citations	Two Systems: 1. Notes and Bibliography (NB): Uses superscript numbers that correspond to Footnotes or Endnotes and a Bibliography . 2. Author-Date (AD): Uses (Author Year, Page) and a Reference List .
Reference Style	Bibliography (NB) or Reference List (AD) (alphabetical by author). Uses full first names. Titles are in Title Case . Titles of major works (books, journals) are italicized .
Example (Book - NB)	1 Jane M. Doe, <i>A History of Early European Law</i> (Academic Press, 2023), 45.
Example (Journal Article - AD)	Johnson, Lee R. 2022. "Ancient Cultures and Environmental Change." <i>Historical Review</i> 75, no. 4 (Winter): 412–25.
Citation Style	(Notes and Bibliography) or (Author-Date)
Common Use	History papers, monographs, journals in the humanities.

4. Harvard

Category	Description
Field of Study	General academic use, widely adopted in the UK, Australia, and parts of Europe (often in Economics, Science, and Business).
Primary Purpose	To provide a clean, clear, and non-numerical way to cite the source's Author and Date instantly in the text.
In-Text Citations	Author-Date system. Uses the author's last name and the year of publication in parentheses: (Author, Year) . For direct quotes, include the page number: (Author, Year, p. X) .
Reference Style	Reference List (alphabetical by author). Uses initials for first names. Article titles are in single quotation marks; journal titles are italicized .
Example (Book)	Smith, J.A. (2023) <i>Principles of Modern Finance</i> . London: Academic Press.
Example (Journal Article)	Baker, L.E. (2022) 'Sustainable practices in corporate governance', <i>Journal of Business Ethics</i> , 75(4), pp. 412–425.
Citation Style	(Author-Date)
Common Use	Business reports, science lab reports, general undergraduate essays across many disciplines.

5. IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers)

Category	Description
Field of Study	Engineering (Electrical, Computer, Software), Computer Science, and Information Technology.
Primary Purpose	To ensure text is clean, non-disruptive, and concise for technical readers, where focus must remain on equations and technical findings.
In-Text Citations	Numerical system. Uses numbers in square brackets, assigned sequentially based on the order of first appearance: [1] . The same number is used for all subsequent citations of that source.
Reference Style	References list (numbered, in order of first citation). Author names are presented as <i>Initial. Last Name</i> . Article titles are in quotation marks . Journal titles are italicized and abbreviated.
Example (Book)	[1] J. M. Doe, <i>Digital Communication Systems</i> . New York: Academic Press, 2023.
Example (Journal Article)	[2] L. R. Johnson and P. E. Williams, "Enhanced algorithm for data encryption," <i>IEEE Trans. Commun.</i> , vol. 75, no. 4, pp. 412–425, 2022.
Citation Style	(Numerical)
Common Use	Technical reports, conference proceedings, engineering journals, and hardware documentation.

6. Vancouver

Category	Description
Field of Study	Biomedical Sciences , Medicine, Public Health, and Physical Sciences (closely tied to the U.S. National Library of Medicine - NLM).
Primary Purpose	To provide quick, standardized, and space-efficient citations crucial for medical and scientific journals, enabling easy cross-referencing to databases like PubMed.
In-Text Citations	Numerical system. Uses numbers, usually in parentheses (1) or square brackets [1], assigned sequentially by order of first appearance.
Reference Style	References list (numbered, in order of first citation). Author names are inverted (<i>Last Name Initial</i>). Journal titles are standardized and abbreviated (e.g., <i>N Engl J Med</i>). No italics are generally used for article or book titles.
Example (Book)	1. Doe JM. Essential medical statistics. New York: Academic Press; 2023.
Example (Journal Article)	2. Johnson LR, Williams PE. Impact of sugar intake on cardiovascular health. J Clin Invest. 2022;132(11):412–25.
Citation Style	(Numerical)
Common Use	Medical and clinical journals, grant proposals, and articles submitted to the International Committee of Medical Journal Editors (ICMJE).

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

This exercise successfully generated a comprehensive comparative resource detailing the six major academic referencing standards.

Component	Summary of Findings
Objective Achievement	The objective of mapping the structure, application, and technical requirements of APA, MLA, Chicago, Harvard, IEEE, and Vancouver styles was met.
Primary Result	A verified, six-style reference guide was created. It clarifies that the choice of citation format directly reflects a discipline's research priorities (e.g., date of publication in APA, sequence of discovery in Vancouver).
Key Takeaway	The distinction between citation methods (Author-Date vs. Numerical) and documentation (Reference List vs. Works Cited) is fundamentally driven by the need to ensure disciplinary credibility and verifiability in publications.